

Week 3: System Administration and Cybersecurity

Backup and Disaster Recovery Plan

Deliverable 1 of 5

Programme	Tech Career Accelerator
Week	Week 3: System Administration and Cybersecurity
Date Range	1st - 5th June
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Objective: Develop comprehensive security, backup, and risk management documentation.

1. Purpose

The purpose of this plan is to ensure that business-critical data and systems can be recovered after data loss, cyberattack, system failure, accidental deletion, theft, natural disaster, or power-related disruption.

2. Scope

- Business documents, shared drives, user files, and operational records.
- Critical servers, databases, cloud-hosted systems, and application data.
- Employee devices that store business information.
- Configuration files for network devices, security tools, and important systems.

3. Backup Schedule

Backup Type	Frequency	Description	Retention Period	Storage Location
Daily incremental backups	Every business day	Backs up only data that changed since the previous backup.	14 days	Local secure backup repository and encrypted cloud storage
Weekly full backups	Every Friday after business hours	Backs up the full selected data set and key system configurations.	8 weeks	Local secure storage and offsite cloud storage
Monthly archive backups	Last business day of each month	Creates a long-term archive copy for compliance, auditing, and historical recovery.	12 months or as required by policy	Encrypted offsite cloud archive

4. Offsite Cloud Storage Requirements

- All critical backups must be copied to secure offsite cloud storage.
- Cloud backups must be encrypted during transfer and while stored.
- Access to backup storage must be restricted to authorised IT personnel only.
- Administrative access must use multi-factor authentication.
- Backup storage should be separated from normal user accounts to reduce ransomware risk.

5. Recovery Objectives

Objective	Definition	Target
Recovery Time Objective (RTO)	The maximum acceptable time needed to restore a system or service after an incident.	Critical systems: within 4 hours; non-critical systems: within 24-48 hours

Objective	Definition	Target
Recovery Point Objective (RPO)	The maximum acceptable amount of data loss measured in time.	No more than 24 hours of data loss for business-critical information

6. Backup Testing and Responsibilities

- IT staff must review backup logs daily to confirm that scheduled backups completed successfully.
- A test restore must be performed at least once per quarter to confirm that backup data can be recovered.
- Failed backups must be investigated and resolved within one business day.
- Backup procedures must be reviewed after major system changes or security incidents.

7. Disaster Recovery Procedure

1. Identify the affected system, data, users, and business impact.
2. Notify the IT manager and relevant business stakeholders.
3. Contain the issue before restoring data, especially if ransomware or malware is suspected.
4. Select the most recent clean backup that meets the RPO target.
5. Restore data or systems according to business priority.
6. Validate restored systems with users before full service resumes.
7. Document the incident, recovery time, data loss, and any follow-up actions.

Approval and Review

This document should be reviewed at least annually and after any major security incident, infrastructure change, or business process change. Updates should be approved by the responsible IT or management representative.

Name	Role	Signature	Date
Jodie S	Team member / Prepared by		
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